an expert in the field, you should never try to implement your own authentication solution. Your users won't be admiring your technical endeavors if their personal data ends up on Pastebin for the world to see.

Instead, we will explore the ready-made ASP.NET Core Identity library, written and tested by experts, that solves the problem of managing users securely. We will look at its default implementation as well as opportunities it provides for customization. You will then learn about the Identity UI package, which includes ready-made pages covering a wide range of user management scenarios. You will use scaffolding to generate versions of some of these pages to customize them to your requirements, and you will implement an email confirmation service for new registrations.

By the end of the chapter, you will have an understanding of the authentication basics and will have used ASP.NET Core Identity to extend your existing database to handle user information storage. You will know how to customize various aspects of the Identity framework to cater to your business needs and will have installed the Identity UI package and learned how to modify it for your application requirements.

9.1 Authentication basics

While the bulk of this chapter concentrates on the ASP.NET Core Identity library, you will begin by understanding the basics behind authentication within an ASP.NET Core application. You will look at how to add authentication services to a Razor Pages application, enable them, and use them to assign an *identity* to a user, so they are no longer *anonymous* to you.

9.1.1 How authentication works

If you have ever been to a trade convention, you are likely to have been challenged to identify yourself at the door, maybe by completing some kind of